★ Recipe No. 02 ★

Classic Cinnamon Rolls

12 rolls. Science!

Two food scientists. Twelve fluffy rolls.

1–2 h + 30–60 min rising | 20–25 min bake at 350 °F | 12 rolls

The good stuff

Cups + spoons · Metric

The dough

unbleached bread flour 568 g · + more for rolling	4 cups
granulated sugar 65 g	⅓ cup
instant dry yeast 11 g	3 tsp
fine table salt 10 g · kosher: weigh 10 g (about 2 tsp)	1¼ tsp
egg 1 · room temperature	1 large
liquid oil 24 g · vegetable, canola, sunflower or olive	2 tbsp
milk 300 ml · whole or 2%	1¼ cups
unsalted butter 28 g · softened	2 tbsp
water 10–20 ml · a splash at a time	as needed

The wet-sand filling

dark brown sugar 220 g · packed	1 cup
ground cinnamon 10 g	4 tsp
all-purpose flour 13 g	1½ tbsp
water 22 ml	1½ tbsp
fine table salt 1.5 g · added for unsalted butter	¼ tsp
unsalted butter 70 g · half-melted, stirred to finish	5 tbsp

The icing

cream cheese 113 g · softened	4 oz
unsalted butter 28 g · softened	2 tbsp
powdered sugar 90 g	¾ cup
pure vanilla extract ½ tsp	½ tsp

Feathery, pull-apart rolls with a wet-sand filling that stays put. Just technique.

Unsalted swap.
She uses salted butter; this sheet uses unsalted, plus ¼ tsp salt in the filling. Her flour cup is heavy: 4 cups = 568 g.

Metal pan, no cream bath.
Cream bath = mushy rolls; glass needs 5–10 min extra. Tacky dough? Add water, never flour. Overnight: shape, cover, chill, then proof.

Method →

Recipe: Christina Marsigliese / Scientifically Sweet

Amounts: as published, cups + grams are the author's own

The BEST Classic Cinnamon Rolls

★ Recipe No. 02 ★

Let's make a mess.

Stand mixer + dough hook, greased 13 × 9-in metal pan, rolling pin, offset spatula, thermometer.

1. **Dry stuff in little piles.**
   Put the flour in the mixer bowl. Add sugar, yeast and salt in separate little piles on top.
   → *Salt not touching the yeast.*

2. **Knead it like you mean it.**
   Add egg, oil, milk and soft butter. Hook on medium-low, 10–15 min; scrape down after 2 min, then every 3–5. Dry or stiff? Add water, 10 ml at a time.
   → *Climbs the hook, then pulls off the bowl; 24–26 °C (75–79 °F).*

3. **Stretch + fold.**
   Stretch and fold on a lightly floured counter until very smooth. Tuck into a ball, oil lightly, cover in a bowl.
   → *The ball's skin pulls smooth without tearing.*

4. **Big rise, quick chill.**
   Rise somewhere warm for 1–2 hours, then chill 15 min (skip in a very cold kitchen).
   → *Nearly tripled in size.*

5. **Pan + wet-sand filling.**
   Grease the pan. Mix sugar, cinnamon, flour and salt. Melt butter only halfway, stir till melted, then stir it in with the water.
   → *Wet-sand sludge: not hot (oils out), not cold (sets up).*

6. **Roll, spread, strip, spiral.**
   No more kneading. Roll to 17 × 14 in, long side facing you; spread filling to the edges. Cut 12 strips (~1¼ × 14 in), roll each into a spiral (or roll a log, slice 12).
   → *Squared-off rectangle, 12 even strips.*

7. **Proof shoulder to shoulder.**
   Spiral side up, snug, no overlaps. Cover loosely, proof 30–60 min. Preheat to 350 °F / 177 °C.
   → *A poke springs back slowly with a slight imprint. Deep dent = over-proofed.*

8. **Bake to temp.**
   Bake 20–25 min. Tent with foil if the tops brown too fast. Cool on a rack 15–20 min.
   → *Evenly golden; center roll at 92–94 °C (198–201 °F).*

9. **Ice it.**
   Beat cream cheese and butter very smooth, then powdered sugar and vanilla. Spread thin over each roll.
   → *Smooth, thick and creamy.*

Recipe: Christina Marsigliese / Scientifically Sweet

Amounts: as published, cups + grams are the author's own